

Bartholomäus Gesius
(1555–1613)

Why Art Thou Cast Down, O My Heart?

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Geistliche Deutsche Lieder (1601), fol. 92v

tr. Matthew Carver, © 2024

Bartholomäus Gesius (1555–1613)

ed. Jonathan Wessler

Soprano 1

1 Why art thou cast down, O my heart? Why vain - ly
2 Thou hast a faith - ful Lord and true, Who know - eth
5 Go in God's name and seek the place And sta - tion
12 Let all to Thee com - mend - ed be; Do as is

Soprano 2

1 Why art thou cast down, O my heart? Why vain - ly cause
2 Thou hast a faith - ful Lord and true, Who know - eth all,
5 Go in God's name and seek the place And sta - tion to
12 Let all to Thee com - mend - ed be; Do as is pleas -

Alto

1 Why art thou cast down, O my heart? Why vain - -
2 Thou hast a faith - ful Lord and true, Who know - -
5 Go in God's name and seek the place And sta - -
12 Let all to Thee com - mend - ed be; Do as -

Tenor

1 Why art thou cast down, O my heart? Why vain - - ly
2 Thou hast a faith - ful Lord and true, Who know - eth
5 Go in God's name and seek the place And sta - tion
12 Let all to Thee com - mend - ed be; Do as is

Bass

1 Why art thou cast down, O my heart? Why vain - ly
2 Thou hast a faith - ful Lord and true, Who know - eth
5 Go in God's name and seek the place And sta - tion
12 Let all to Thee com - mend - ed be; Do as is

6

cause thee pain and smart? If oft thy stores be scant,
all, and well can view How much and what thou lack'st,
to which God in grace Hath point - ed thee to go.
pleas - ing best to Thee: Give lit - tle or give much,

thee pain and smart? If oft thy stores be scant,
and well can view How much and what thou lack'st,
which God in grace Hath point - ed thee to go.
- ing best to Thee: Give lit - tle or give much,

- ly cause thee pain and smart? If oft thy stores be scant,
- eth all, and well can view How much and what thou lack'st,
- tion to which God in grace Hath point - ed thee to go.
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to which God in grace Hath point - ed thee to go.
pleas - ing best to Thee: Give lit - tle or give much,

[10]

If on a de - sert hill thou lie, And all a - round be waste and dry?
 And what He soon will do for thee, That all may end up pros - - p'rous - ly.
 The grass may un - fa - mil - iar be, But well, if God but bless - it thee!
 As shall to our sal - va - tion tend, And I will praise Thee with - - out end.

WHY art thou cast down, O my heart?
 Why vainly cause thee pain and smart?
 If oft thy stores be scant,
 If on a desert hill thou lie,
 And all around be waste and dry?

5 Go in God's name and seek the place
 And station to which God in grace
 Hath pointed thee to go.
 The grass may unfamiliar be,
 But well, if God but bless it thee!

9 God, help me put my confidence
 Forever in Thy might immense
 And Thine all-knowing eye,
 Which long before me clearly sees
 What serveth best, my ills to ease.

2 Thou hast a faithful Lord and true,
 Who knoweth all, and well can view
 How much and what thou lack'st,
 And what He soon will do for thee,
 That all may end up prosp'rously.

6 Hast thou not much? Groan not, nor grieve;
 What God will give thee, that receive,
 And thou hast quite enough.
 Thou wilt with little be content,
 And more will be the store unspent.

10 I know Thy tender heart will deign,
 To have compassion on my pain
 And readily assist.
 Now that the need and great and high,
 Thou with Thy comfort standest nigh.

3 For though thou knowest not the way,
 God is almighty still as aye,
 And only proveth thee,
 To see if thou dost set more store
 By means than by His mighty pow'r

7 Oh, God, if I should calculate
 And early rise and stay up late
 To ponder what I need,
 I then would follow Philip's vice
 And all the world would not suffice.

11 Thy means may never meet the eye,
 Shall it therefore Thy pow'r defy
 And Thine almighty hand?
 Thou canst of little manage soon
 A mighty supper for Thine own.

4 Fret not then at thy table great,
 And scarce enough to fill a plate,
 But be with God content,
 Who maketh little long to last,
 Where plenty oft is squandered fast.

8 Thus many nights of grief result,
 If I the faithless world consult,
 Nor do I know the cure.
 Those who should help and comfort me
 Will but increase my agony.

12 Let all to Thee commended be;
 Do as is pleasing best to Thee:
 Give little or give much,
 As shall to our salvation tend,
 And I will praise Thee without end.